title: "Activities And Social Engagement Policy" effectiveDate: "" reviewDate: "" version: "1.0"

Activities and Social Engagement Policy

Policy Title: Activities and Social Engagement

Effective Date: [Insert Date]

Review Date: [Insert Date – usually annually]

Version: 1.0

Applies to: All residents, staff, agency workers, and volunteers at [INSERT CARE HOME NAME]

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1. Policy Statement

At [INSERT CARE HOME NAME], we believe that meaningful activities and social engagement are essential for maintaining residents' wellbeing, dignity, independence, and quality of life.

We aim to:

- Provide a varied programme of meaningful activities tailored to residents' interests, abilities, and needs.
- Promote inclusion, social connections, and a sense of purpose.
- Support physical, emotional, cognitive, and spiritual wellbeing through engagement opportunities.
- Comply with the Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014 and CQC Fundamental Standards.

2. Purpose

This policy ensures that:

- All residents have access to stimulating and enjoyable activities.
- Social engagement is integrated into daily care planning.
- Barriers to participation are identified and minimised.
- Staff, families, and volunteers work collaboratively to enhance quality of life.

3. Scope

This policy applies to:

- Residents – all individuals living at the home.
- Staff – all employees and volunteers who support resident activities.
- Environment – indoor, outdoor, and community settings used for activities.

4. Roles and Responsibilities

Registered Manager:

- Oversees the implementation of this policy.
- Ensures sufficient resources are available for activities.
- Monitors activity provision through audits, resident feedback, and care reviews.

Activities Coordinator (if applicable):

- Plans, organises, and delivers activities that meet diverse resident needs.
- Encourages participation and adapts activities to individual preferences and abilities.
- Maintains records of participation and outcomes.

Care Staff:

- Support residents in participating in daily activities.
- Encourage independence while offering assistance where required.
- Document engagement in residents' care records.

Volunteers and Families:

- Encouraged to contribute to activity planning and delivery.
- Involved in events, celebrations, and outings.

5. Activities Programme

5.1 Individual Activities

- Person-centred activities based on residents' life history, hobbies, culture, and interests.
- One-to-one engagement for those unable to participate in group activities.

5.2 Group Activities

- Social events such as music, crafts, games, and exercise.
- Religious, cultural, and seasonal celebrations.
- Outings to local community venues and events.

5.3 Daily Living Activities

- Encouraging residents to participate in household activities (e.g., gardening, baking).
- Promoting independence and purpose in everyday life.

5.4 Community Engagement

- Opportunities for intergenerational projects, visiting groups, and local partnerships.
- Use of technology (video calls, online events) to reduce isolation.

6. Accessibility and Inclusion

- Activities adapted to residents' physical, cognitive, and sensory needs.
- Assistive equipment and support provided where necessary.
- Residents' cultural, spiritual, and personal preferences respected.

7. Monitoring and Review

- Residents' activity preferences reviewed regularly as part of care planning.

- Feedback gathered from residents, families, and staff.
- Activity records and participation logs maintained.
- Regular audits conducted to ensure variety and effectiveness.

8. Training

Staff receive training in:

- Person-centred activity planning.
- Dementia-friendly engagement approaches.
- Communication and motivational skills.
- Refresher training provided annually or as guidance changes.

9. References

- Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014
- CQC Fundamental Standards – Regulation 9 (Person-Centred Care)
- NICE Guideline NG97: Dementia – assessment, management, and support
- Social Care Institute for Excellence (SCIE) – Meaningful Activities in Care

10. Related Policies

- Equality, Diversity & Inclusion Policy
- Mental Health & Wellbeing Policy (Staff & Residents)
- Safeguarding Adults Policy
- Risk Assessment Policy
- Nutrition & Hydration Policy
- Staff Training & Development / Supervision Policy

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